

NHANES Sample and Blood Pressure Summary

Hamed

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Introduction

The National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey combines interviews and health examinations to describe the health of the United States population. This report summarizes the three survey waves represented in the cleaned course dataset. It describes the sample composition and the available systolic blood-pressure measurements using tables designed for precise comparison.

Sample size and male participants

Table 1. Overall sample size and male participants by survey wave

Wave	Sample size	Male, n	Male, %
2013-2014	10,175	5,003	49.2
2015-2016	9,971	4,892	49.1
2017-2018	9,254	4,557	49.2

Note: The shaded row has the largest overall sample size.

The 2013-2014 wave contains the largest sample. Across all three waves, the numbers of males and females are similar, with males accounting for roughly half of each wave. Reporting both counts and percentages supports comparison even though the wave sample sizes differ.

Ethnicity by wave

Table 2. Ethnicity counts and percentages within each survey wave

Wave	Ethnicity	n	%
2013-2014	White	3,674	36.1
2013-2014	Black	2,267	22.3
2013-2014	Mexican	1,730	17.0
2013-2014	Asian	1,074	10.6
2013-2014	Other Hispanic	960	9.4
2013-2014	Other	470	4.6
2015-2016	White	3,066	30.7
2015-2016	Black	2,129	21.4

Wave	Ethnicity	n	%
2015-2016	Mexican	1,921	19.3
2015-2016	Other Hispanic	1,308	13.1
2015-2016	Asian	1,042	10.5
2015-2016	Other	505	5.1
2017-2018	White	3,150	34.0
2017-2018	Black	2,115	22.9
2017-2018	Mexican	1,367	14.8
2017-2018	Asian	1,168	12.6
2017-2018	Other Hispanic	820	8.9
2017-2018	Other	634	6.9

Note: Percentages are calculated within wave. The largest displayed percentage is shaded.

White participants form the largest category in each wave. The table uses the more detailed ethnicity_2 classification because it identifies Asian participants separately instead of combining them with the broad Other group. Group boundaries help the reader compare categories within one wave before moving to the next.

Average systolic blood pressure

Table 3. Summary statistics for average systolic blood pressure by wave

Wave	Available n	Minimum	Maximum	Median	Mean	SD
2013-2014	7,528	64.7	228.7	115.3	118.3	18.1
2015-2016	7,363	74.0	231.3	117.3	120.4	18.4
2017-2018	6,713	72.7	234.0	118.0	121.7	20.3

Note: Average SBP is the participant-level mean of all available systolic readings. The row with the highest mean is shaded.

The number of participants with an average systolic blood-pressure value is smaller than the total sample because some participants have no usable systolic readings. The mean and median are close within each wave, while the minimum, maximum, and standard deviation show substantial individual variation. Calculating the participant-level average first prevents participants with more readings from receiving more weight in the wave summary.

References

National Center for Health Statistics. (2026). *National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey*. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. <https://www.cdc.gov/nchs/nhanes/> (accessed October 4, 2026).